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Advancing Agentic AI

AI agents may be one of the most promising verticals of the AI x crypto space, though long term value accrual mechanisms remain unclear.

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AI agents have surfaced as a revolutionary theme not only in crypto, but also in the broader technology sphere. The concept of an autonomous entity capable of analyzing and taking real-time decisions on market newsfeeds or other external data has captured the imaginations of many institutional investors. Elsewhere, some tech industry leaders have argued that agentic AI could eventually displace the massive software as a service (SaaS) industry. That is, a well trained AI agent could, in principle, accomplish any task involving a digital interface.

We think crypto rails could play a central role in such a future as the primary value transfer mechanism for AI agents. Crypto's inherently programmatic nature and permissionless design support the scaling and deployment of a near limitless number of such agents, enabling a wider range of use cases from managing onchain portfolios to paying for offline services. In light of this potential opportunity, agentic AI crypto assets peaked at more than \$20B in market cap in early January, before ending the month closer to \$8B.

The recent dip may suggest that expectations for AI agents have started to outpace the actual development of the technology itself. And while we anticipate this theme will transform the crypto x AI landscape in the long run, its short-term applications are constrained by integration and agent differentiation challenges as well as unclear long-term utility for agent tokens. In other words, it may yet take longer to realize the full potential of AI agents than many may realize.

For more details, see our [full report](#).

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